

Nikita Kazeev

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Research Scientist at the intersection of AI and Physics

Work Experience

Perfomax

May 2026–present

AI Advisor

- **AI Strategy & Platform Architecture :**

- Advised on AI/ML strategy, product implementation, and technical design for the platform.

National University of Singapore

2022–present

Postdoc under Kostya Novoselov

- **Leadership :**

- Speaker search and selection for the 500-person AI4X 2025 conference.
- Main organizer of the ICLR 2025 workshop on multiscale machine learning.

- **Transformer for generating symmetric crystals :**

- Created a generative model for material design based on symmetry inductive bias.
- Implemented the model in PyTorch.
- Achieved the best generation quality and diversity among space-group-conditioned models.
- Led a team of 6.

CERN [Yandex → HSE University]

2014–2022

Researcher

[2025 Breakthrough Prize in Fundamental Physics](#) as a member of LHCb.

- **Generative models uncertainty estimation :**

- Developed the first methods for estimating uncertainty of conditional GANs.
- Led a team of 3 students.

- **Generative models for fast simulation :**

- Developed a GAN-based machine learning model for high-fidelity simulation of a Cherenkov detector trained on tabular data.
- Achieved approximately 10^5 speed-up compared to the ab-initio simulator.

Education

Higher School of Economics (HSE University)

2016–2020

PhD in Computer Science, supervisor [Andrey Ustyuzhanin](#); [Machine Learning for particle identification in the LHCb detector](#).

Sapienza — Università di Roma

2016–2020

PhD in Physics (double degree with HSE), supervisor [Barbara Sciascia](#).

Product Management course at Yandex

Spring 2018

Focused coursework in product strategy and execution.

Yandex School of Data Analysis

2013–2015

Master's level CS course covering algorithms, machine learning, deep learning, and distributed systems.

Moscow Institute of Physics and Technology

MS in Physics (2014–2016): Optimisation of data processing of the LHCb experiment.

BS in Physics (2010–2014): Study of the quantum states of the electrons in nonideal plasma and selected molecules using wave packet molecular dynamics with packet splitting.

Mentorship

- Mentored 9 students ([1](#), [2](#), [3](#), [4](#), [5](#), [6](#), [7](#), [8](#), [9](#)), 3 interns, and student workshop projects ([1](#), [20](#)).

- Student council member from 2013 to 2016, leading several dormitory-scale IT projects.
- Co-PI of a \$3.4m AI Singapore grant on multiscale machine learning.

Teaching & Outreach

- Pitch research to the general public through major newspaper coverage ([1](#), [2](#)), blog posts ([1](#), [2](#)), a [science slam](#), interviews ([1](#), [2](#)), and a public [talk](#).
- Lecturer in the [Coursera Advanced Machine Learning specialisation](#), which is [award-winning](#).
- Delivered more than 20 [conference talks](#).

Service

- Reviewer for RSC Advances, Machine Learning: Science and Technology, and AI for Accelerated Materials Design workshops at NeurIPS and ICLR (2023–2025).
- Peer Staff Supporter at NUS, serving as a first-line support for mental wellbeing.

Skills

ML & AI (Structured, non-text, domain-specific data) ·
Python (Research coding) ·
PyTorch (Deep learning) ·
Research Writing & Speaking ·
Leadership & Mentorship

Selected Publications

1. **Kazeev, Nikita**, and Ian Babich. [Foresight-Phys: A Benchmark for Forecasting the Results of Physical Experiments](#). OpenReview, June 2026.
2. **Kazeev, Nikita**, and Phan Bui Nhat Huyen. [Position: Align AI to Our Aspirations, Not Our Flaws](#). Pluralistic Alignment Workshop at ICML 2026, June 2026.
3. Nian Liu, **Nikita Kazeev**, Stephen Gregory Dale, Artem Maevskiy, Yuwei Zeng, Ryoji Kubo, Pengru Huang, Thomas Laurent, Yann LeCun, Kostya S. Novoselov, and Xavier Bresson. [Crys-JEPA: Accelerating Crystal Discovery via Embedding Screening and Generative Refinement](#). arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.14759, May 2026.
4. Nian Liu, Yuwei Zeng, Ryoji Kubo, **Nikita Kazeev**, Stephen Gregory Dale, Artem Maevskiy, Pengru Huang, Thomas Laurent, Kostya S. Novoselov, and Xavier Bresson. [Composable Crystals: Controllable Materials Discovery via Concept Learning](#). arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.14769, May 2026.
5. Alexandre Duval, Siddharth Betala, Samuel P. Gleason, Andy Xu, Georgia Channing, Daniel Levy, Ali Ramlaoui, Clémentine Fourier, Chaitanya K. Joshi, **Nikita Kazeev**, Sékou-Oumar Kaba, Félix Therrien, Alex Hernández-García, Rocío Mercado, N M Anoop Krishnan. [LeMat-GenBench: Bridging the gap between crystal generation and materials discovery](#). AI for Accelerated Materials Design - NeurIPS 2025 / arXiv preprint arXiv:2512.04562, October 2025.
6. **Kazeev, Nikita**, et al. [WyckoffTransformer: Generation of Symmetric Crystals](#). ICML 2025, May 2025.
7. Anderlini, L., Chimpoesch, C., **Kazeev, N.**, Shishigina, A., & LHCb collaboration. [Generative models uncertainty estimation](#). Journal of Physics: Conference Series, 2023. *I'm the corresponding author.*
8. Derkach, D., **Kazeev, N.**, Ratnikov, F., Ustyuzhanin, A., & Volokhova, A. (2019). [Cherenkov detectors fast simulation using neural networks](#). *Nuclear Instruments and Methods in Physics Research Section A*. *I'm the corresponding author.*